

Alicia Moreno

Director of Engineering

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SUMMARY

Engineering leader with 12 years of experience scaling platform organizations from 8 to 70 engineers. Delivered a payments rearchitecture that unlocked \$120M in annual transaction volume and reduced infrastructure cost per transaction 61%. Hires, develops, and retains senior engineers; three direct reports promoted to staff or manager in the last two years.

SKILLS

Leadership: Org design, Hiring and performance management, Mentorship, Executive communication
Strategy: Technical roadmapping, Build vs. buy analysis, Budget ownership, Vendor negotiation
Technical: Distributed systems, Event-driven architecture, API platform design, Cloud cost governance
Stack: Java, Go, Python, Kubernetes, Kafka, AWS, PostgreSQL, Terraform
Process: Agile at scale, SLO and incident programs, Design review, Compliance (SOC 2, PCI DSS)

EXPERIENCE

Director of Engineering, Platform

Global Fintech Company

Feb 2021 – Present

New York, NY

- Scaled the platform organization from 22 to 70 engineers across 7 teams while holding voluntary attrition under 6%.
- Sponsored the payments rearchitecture that unlocked \$120M in annual transaction volume and cut cost per transaction 61%.
- Owned a \$14M annual engineering budget; renegotiated cloud and vendor contracts for \$2.6M in recurring savings.
- Instituted a company-wide incident and SLO program that reduced customer-impacting sev-1 events 68% in 18 months.
- Partnered with Product and Compliance to achieve SOC 2 Type II and PCI DSS Level 1 certification on schedule.

Senior Engineering Manager

Enterprise SaaS Company

Mar 2017 – Jan 2021

New York, NY

- Managed 3 teams (24 engineers) delivering the core API platform used by 900 enterprise customers.
- Drove the monolith-to-services decomposition, improving deploy frequency from biweekly to 40+ times per week.
- Built the engineering career ladder and calibration process adopted across a 200-person organization.
- Recruited 31 engineers, raising the senior-and-above ratio from 35% to 58%.

Engineering Manager

Cloud Storage Startup

Jun 2014 – Feb 2017

Boston, MA

- Grew the founding backend team from 4 to 14 engineers through Series B.

- Led the storage tiering project that reduced hot-storage cost 44% at 8PB scale.
- Introduced on-call, runbooks, and postmortems, taking uptime from 99.5% to 99.95%.

Senior Software Engineer

Enterprise Infrastructure Vendor

Jul 2012 – May 2014

Boston, MA

- Designed the replication layer for a distributed block store deployed at 40+ enterprise customers.
- Led the migration to automated integration testing, cutting release qualification from 3 weeks to 4 days.

PROJECTS

Engineering Levels Framework | *Internal, open-sourced*

github.com/amoreno/levels

- Published the career ladder and calibration rubric used at two companies; adopted by 15+ external teams.

EDUCATION

M.S. in Computer Science

Carnegie Mellon University

May 2012

Pittsburgh, PA

B.S. in Electrical Engineering

Boston University

May 2010

Boston, MA

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional (2022)
- Certified Kubernetes Administrator, CNCF (2021)